

DBS Group Holdings

First Take: Core profits up 24% q/q, 2% beat vs Street, steady AQ; re-rating to resume

Our First Take: DBS announced 1Q26 net profits of S\$2,930mn, up 1% y/y, 30% q/q, 2% above JPMe and about a 2% beat vs. Street. NII (-3% q/q) and NIM (1.89%, -4bps q/q) were in-line (LDR in-line at 72.9%). Deposit gr was 12% in constant currency, and 9% in SGD terms. This is a b-t-e outcome, and guidance of HSD deposit gr suggests continued deposit flows at the bank. Non-II was up 40% q/q, in-line with our forecasts as well. Fee income was a small beat, led by WM. NNM at \$10bn was in-line, with AuM gr of 1% q/q to \$492bn a touch weaker, likely due to MTM as of 31st March. Costs were better, leading to 38.3% CIR, which is quite positive. Provisions came in at the lower end of guidance at 17bps (we had them at the upper end, 20bps), with a small 3% improvement in NPLs to 1% (formation low) and NPA coverage moved up to 131%. The guidance suggests reserve adequacy even in the face of ongoing shifts which may lead to portfolio stresses. CET1 of 14.8% was 20bps lower q/q, likely due to faster RWAg q/q. DPS was flat q/q at 81c (66c regular + 15c special); in-line. DBS has been range bound since 4Q25 results which were seasonally weak, and had HK related AQ charge. These results clear the air, with a high-quality delivery and guidance, accordingly the stock should resume an uptrend. Maintain OW.

These results have set the bar high for UOB and OCBC. In case there is any miss on NIM/AQ at peers, we expect sharply weaker stock price action. WM trends at OCBC should be robust, but it is difficult to have a strongly positive read on AQ due to higher EM Asean exposure at OCBC and UOB, with NIM/NII impact more at risk due to different sensitivities to Hibor/SOFR. We recommend investors switch from OCBC and UOB (UW on both) into DBS (and SGX), within the sector.

Key Positives

Fee income was strong, with WM reaching a new record in the quarter. Loan and deposit growth were slightly better than expected at 2%/3% q/q respectively. Costs were managed better than our expectations.

Key Negatives/Question Marks

Other income was a small miss, partly due to markets trading (down 8% y/y).

Likely Changes to Consensus

We expect limited changes post results.

Expected Stock Reaction

We expect a positive stock price reaction.

See page 4 for analyst certification and important disclosures, including non-US analyst disclosures.

Overweight

DBSM.SI, DBS SP

Price (29 Apr 26): S\$56.56

Price Target (Jun-27): S\$62.00



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Conference call details

DBS is hosting a media and analyst briefing at 10:30/11:30am HKT today. Please let us know if you are keen to join.

Table 1: DBS: 1Q26 earnings review

P&L (\$\$mn)	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	1Q26A	1Q26E	YoY	QoQ	JPM
Net Interest Income	3,681	3,648	3,578	3,593	3,494	3,506	-5%	-3%	0%
Non-Interest Income	2,301	2,149	2,421	1,791	2,516	2,508	9%	40%	0%
Net Fee Income	1,275	1,167	1,357	1,099	1,482	1,429	16%	35%	4%
Other Non-interest Income	1,026	982	1,064	692	1,034	1,079	1%	49%	-4%
Operating Revenue	5,982	5,797	5,999	5,384	6,010	6,014	0%	12%	0%
Operating Costs	(2,214)	(2,270)	(2,393)	(2,372)	(2,302)	(2,351)	4%	-3%	-2%
PPOP	3,768	3,527	3,606	3,012	3,708	3,663	-2%	23%	1%
Provisions	(331)	(139)	(130)	(214)	(190)	(230)	-43%	-11%	-17%
Other Provisions	(6)	(9)	(6)	(2)	(6)	(3)	0%	200%	100%
Pre-Tax	3,437	3,388	3,476	2,798	3,512	3,433	2%	26%	2%
Core Attributable Profit	2,897	2,824	2,954	2,358	2,930	2,871	1%	24%	2%
Non-Recurring items	0	0	0	(100)	-	0	NM	-100%	NM
Net Attributable Profit	2,897	2,824	2,954	2,258	2,930	2,871	1%	30%	2%
DPS (\$\$)	0.75	0.75	0.75	0.81	0.81	0.81	8%	0%	0%
Gross Loans	442,000	439,100	443,000	451,065	459,000	453,342	4%	2%	1%
Net Loans	435,295	433,046	437,027	445,011	453,180	447,243	4%	2%	1%
Deposits	575,663	573,965	596,073	610,023	629,868	622,164	9%	3%	1%
NPA	4,861	4,686	4,627	4,843	4,720	4,888	-3%	-3%	-3%
							Change in bps		
NIM	2.12%	2.05%	1.96%	1.93%	1.89%	1.89%	(23)	(4)	0
CIR	37.0%	39.2%	39.9%	44.1%	38.3%	39.1%	129	(575)	(80)
LDR	76.8%	76.5%	74.3%	73.9%	72.9%	72.9%	(391)	(107)	1
CASA Ratio	52.6%	52.4%	53.3%	54.5%	54.7%	54.5%	202	15	14
Total Provisions/Gross Loans (bps)	30	13	12	19	17	20	(13)	(2)	(4)
NPL Ratio	1.10%	1.01%	1.00%	1.03%	1.00%	1.03%	(10)	(3)	(3)
(Total allowances + RLAR)/NPA	137%	137%	139%	130%	131%	129%	(580)	131	158
CET1 (Fully phased-in)	15.2%	15.1%	15.2%	15.0%	14.8%	15.0%	(36)	(22)	(24)
CET1 (Transitory)	17.4%	17.0%	16.9%	17.0%	16.9%	16.9%	(46)	(12)	177

Source: Company reports, J.P. Morgan estimates.

DBS Group Holdings (Overweight; Price Target: S\$62.00)

Investment Thesis

We are OW on DBS.

- DBS has delivered one of the best RoE expansions in the last decade as technology and process-led changes across the franchise have resulted in better growth, efficiency and returns. The bank's digital strength is driving gains in loan market share, WM, as well as underwriting.
- The bank's commitment to and delivery of payouts in numerous forms (progressively increasing regular dividends, special dividends and buyback) allows investors to pay a multiple for the income stream.
- The bank has restructured to lower its loan intensity (48% loans to assets in 2028E vs. 63% in 2017), with the WM business contributing an increasingly larger share. We expect S\$40bn NNM in 2026E (flat vs. 2025, which was a record), but fee growth could be lower in a period of market volatility.
- The shifts in oil prices could lead to asset quality issues across the sector. We expect higher NPL formation at 38bps in FY26, on par with 2020 highs. We expect the bank to book provisions at the higher end of guidance at 20bps. Any indication of a sharp pick-up in NPL formation would be a catalyst for de-rating. A key risk area could be trade-related exposure. Stage 2 loans are likely to move up in 1Q26, with NPLs following in 2Q/3Q.
- We expect 2026 EPS to mark a low for the next 5Y. Hence, the regular DPS of S\$3.06 and part of the special can stay intact. We estimate the bank can potentially pay over \$3.50 DPS (2026E) for years to come.

Valuation

Our Jun-27 PT of S\$62 is based on a fair P/B of 2.35x, assuming a normalized RoE of 16.2%, a risk-free rate of 3.85%, a cost of capital of 9.4% and a growth rate of 4.3%.

Risks to Rating and Price Target

Upside catalysts include: (1) further increases in DPS; (2) resilient GDP growth, leading to better-than-expected growth and asset quality; (3) sustained improvements in underwriting and monitoring, leading to lower-than-expected credit costs; (4) better-than-expected efficiency gains due to digital investments; and (5) better-than-expected WM performance on sustained inflows into SG.

Downside risks include: (1) dividend disappointment; (2) asset quality deterioration, potentially from trade-related exposure or CRE; and (3) faster and/or larger Fed rate cuts or decline in SORA, which would drive a larger than expected NIM compression. Any acquisition would come with two-sided risks.

Companies Discussed in This Report (all prices in this report as of market close on 29 April 2026, unless otherwise indicated)
OCBC Bank(OCBC.SI/S\$21.66/UW), Singapore Exchange(SGXL.SI/S\$21.29/OW), United Overseas Bank (UOB)(UOBH.SI/S\$35.78/UW)

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DBS Group Holdings (DBSM.SI, DBS SP) Price Chart



Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Dec 11, 2001. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

OCBC Bank (OCBC.SI, OCBC SP) Price Chart



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Singapore Exchange (SGXL.SI, SGX SP) Price Chart



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United Overseas Bank (UOB) (UOBH.SI, UOB SP) Price Chart



Date	Rating	Price (\$\$)	Price Target (\$\$)
05-Oct-23	N	28.07	28
09-Dec-23	N	27.58	27
13-Mar-24	N	28.28	30
03-Jul-24	N	31.65	32.5
06-Oct-24	N	31.86	34
10-Nov-24	OW	35.69	41
14-Jan-25	OW	36.80	43
23-Mar-25	N	37.95	40
21-May-25	N	35.40	37
13-Jul-25	N	36.86	38
08-Aug-25	N	35.81	36.5
10-Sep-25	UW	35.57	32.5
28-Nov-25	N	33.89	34
25-Jan-26	UW	39.50	34
17-Apr-26	UW	37.52	33

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
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